

their negative emotions to dull their wits and cancel their courage.

In the greatest nation in the world, a nation that fairly throbs with opportunity, they settle down to live in want. Some member of the family may make some gesture toward lifting himself out of his rut, but it always turns out to be a feeble gesture that lacks follow through. Perhaps it salves his conscience to have this gesture to point to for the rest of his life. Worse yet, whole families are brought up in the belief that God intended them to be poor! Surely it must be the final twist of fear which equates the idea of God with the idea of persecution.

To be poor and not to like being poor is a good step toward becoming rich. But put aside your *fear* of poverty. See it rather as merely that point from which you take off. Let your intimate knowledge of the unwanted condition become a sustaining force as you drive toward the condition you do want—prosperity, even opulence.

Let your present necessity for pinching pennies make you aware of the power of money. Let your lack of capital make you aware of the many ways you can make use of other people's money merely by paying them a fair fee for their money's hire.

Know that much education is free, that self-education in some fields can be better than school education, that vast stores of information may be used free, that industry and trade stand with open arms to receive the willing worker. Know that our economy is so vast and various that any special talent can find the place where it is needed; and our economy is filled with unmet needs which *you* can meet.

I forbear from giving you a list of the many well-known men who began their lives in poverty. We have met many of them and shall meet others. *Cast out fear of poverty and drive ahead.*

**2. The fear of criticism.** Your mind has limitless power to make a dream come true—provided you allow your mind to work unhampered. Few fears hamper a mind so quickly as the fear of criticism. It can stop you before you get started. And yet it is nothing but the influence of another mind or other minds—a negative influence which often is only imagined. A person who is filled with fear of criticism often will not put forth his ideas lest he be rebuffed, and so he loses his great gifts of imagination and self-reliance.